

How to Sell Skio

Rep Enablement Course

Transitioning from Recharge to Skio as our default platform · Effective Q4

Introduction:

Recharge AE's, welcome back to school! This textbook is a guide that will get you to a point where you can ideally sell Skio with confidence. You already know how to sell subscription software, so this is a *translation*, not a complete restart. As we near a transition to Skio being the default platform we sell to new merchants, take your time to get up to speed. This guide will help improve your knowledge of Skio and thereby (hopefully) increase your commission checks starting next month 😊.

Work through this textbook in order: understand the acquisition narrative and talk tracks, learn the Skio product, learn how to demo the platform, and practice competitive talk tracks.

The course has five parts:

- **The Narrative:** why we acquired Skio and how to tell that story
- **The Product:** how Skio actually works: a feature reference, organized by acquisition and retention
- **The Demo:** how to run a great demo: the flow, talk tracks, and what to show
- **Talk Tracks & Competitive:** new positioning and objection handling
- **Skio Certification:** hands-on homework in your demo store + a capstone to get certified

Homework: Getting your 'Skio Diploma':

Throughout each section, there will be specific points where you will be asked to verify and validate your learning. Through a combination of call-recordings, recorded Loom videos and quizzes, you'll be tested on your knowledge as you read the guide. Every AE needs to pass each part before they're allowed to start selling Skio as the default.

Ultimately, each AE will have to pass a mock-demo with their manager. This guide will help ensure you pass that on your first attempt. Please do not skim through the material, take your time and soak it all in.

Section 1 • The Narrative: The Acquisition Story

This is where every conversation starts, so it comes first. The moment you pull up the platform, the merchant sees the word *Skio*, and you need an answer that sounds confident and planned, not defensive or improvised. The goal of this section is that you can tell the acquisition story in 30 seconds and mean it.

Read the internal context below so you understand *the why* behind the acquisition. Then use the approved external script when you're actually in front of a merchant. Don't read the internal reasoning to customers verbatim, it's for your understanding, not their ears.

Why we acquired Skio (internal context, for your understanding)

The short version, straight from Oisín (Recharge CEO) and Aidan (Skio CEO):

1. Skio was winning our best customers.

When Recharge looked at its churn, especially the biggest and fastest-growing merchants, roughly **65% of it was going to Skio**. Four other players split the rest in the 5–10% range, but Skio was the outlier. Brands would graduate off Recharge and onto Skio, and Recharge had a difficult time ripping them back out. That was an existential signal, not a minor competitive loss.

2. The market moved, and Skio was built for where it went.

Recharge was originally built for developers, an API-first platform. The market shifted from "APIs and developers" to "out-of-the-box and turnkey". Then later, it shifted again to "turnkey *plus* a great partner who helps me grow." The joining of great software with great services behind it. Skio was built natively for that world: out-of-the-box, CPG-focused, built for high-growth merchants, with strong services and CSM support built in.

3. Focus won the best part of the market.

Skio deliberately said no to most of the market and focused on mid-market-and-up CPG brands, beauty, supplements, food & beverage, home. That focus let them deliver a high level of tech, support, and guidance that generalist platforms (Recharge included) couldn't match. As Oisín put it, "you are what you say no to." Your boundaries, choices, and refusals define your character and values just as much as the things you accept. Recharge accepted everyone, Skio was more deliberate on serving only their best customers.

4. Best tech + best team.

Under the hood, Skio's engineering foundation is the differentiator, built natively on Shopify's Subscriptions API, on modern infrastructure (Vercel, BigQuery), with an intentionally structured subscription data model sitting right next to Shopify. That's why competitors "can't match the quality of data" or the quality of features. Paired with a services team merchants actually want as a growth partner, it's the combination that made Skio the platform to beat.

5. The plan post-acquisition: accelerate, don't interfere.

Recharge isn't absorbing Skio and slowing it down. The explicit goal is to put the fire-power of Recharge's size and reliable infrastructure behind what's already working, accelerate the Skio roadmap and let the team keep doing what made them the market leader. Skio is where our R&D investment goes for brands going forward.

► [Listen: Oisin on why we bought Skio \(Gong\)](#)

Proof the tech is the crown jewel, a few things Skio shipped that competitors still haven't matched:

- **Cancel-flow A/B testing**, Klaviyo-style testing, rebuilt from the ground up rather than bolted on
- **Advanced segmentation + Klaviyo sync**, slice and dice subscriber data and push it to Klaviyo
- **Subscription-first loyalty**, the first loyalty platform built specifically for subscription brands
- **Bundles & volume discounts**, "buy more, save more" gamified logic; discounts scale up and down as subscribers add or remove products

► [Listen: Aidan on Skio's tech philosophy & standout features \(Gong\)](#)

The approved talk track (say this to merchants)

Use this near the top of a demo, right as you're about to share your screen, so the Skio branding is framed before merchants can wonder about it. Keep it to ~30 seconds. Make it yours, but hit these beats:

"Before we jump in, a quick bit of context. You're going to see Skio when we pull up the platform today. Skio is now a Recharge brand; we acquired them earlier this year, and the Skio tech is where we're investing our R&D going forward for brands just like you.

Skio's built natively on Shopify's Subscriptions API, which means we ship faster than anyone in the space, stay closest to Shopify's roadmap, and everything works out of the box without custom workarounds.

The brands you probably know in this space, Grüns, IM8, Dose Daily, Neuro Gum, Instant Hydration, they're all running on the Skio tech. These are the fastest-growing subscription brands, and what you're about to see is exactly what they're running on."

Why this works:

- **Leads with confidence.** "Now a Recharge brand" + "where we're investing R&D" frames the acquisition as strength, not disruption.
- **Gives one crisp technical reason.** "Built natively on Shopify's Subscriptions API" = faster shipping, closest to Shopify, no custom workarounds. One reason, said well, beats five.

- **Ends on social proof.** Naming the fastest-growing brands the merchant already admires makes them want to be in that group.

Proof points & names to drop

Marquee brands on the Skio tech: **Grüns, IM8, Dose Daily, Neuro Gum, Instant Hydration**. Use the ones closest to your merchant's category (supplements, beauty, food & beverage, hydration). "A brand like you is already running on this" is far more persuasive than a feature list.

Do / Don't:

✓ Do

Frame the acquisition as investment and acceleration, better tech, more resources, faster roadmap. Lead the demo with the talk track before sharing your screen. Anchor on the native Shopify Subscriptions API story and name-drop peer brands. Project continuity: same company, stronger platform.

✗ Don't

Don't disparage Recharge, it's our company. Frame it as evolution, not as "the old thing was bad." Don't imply anyone is being forced off a platform or read the internal churn numbers to a customer. Don't over-promise on migration specifics or timelines that aren't confirmed, if unsure, say you'll follow up.
Don't turn the 30-second story into a five-minute monologue. Say it, then get into the product.

Language tip, Skio is "us," not "them"

Post-acquisition, Skio is our tech. Say "we," "us," "our Skio tech," "we acquired", never refer to Skio as a separate company you're weighing against Recharge. Frame any move to Skio as an upgrade, not a switch: "the brands that look like you are upgrading to our Skio tech." Never position against Recharge, it's the same company now. The old Skio pitch leaned hard on beating Recharge ("following their coattails," "taking down their brands"). That language is retired; using it means trashing our own company.

📎 HOMEWORK

Record a short Loom of yourself delivering the acquisition narrative and talk track from memory, no reading. This is the single most-used line you'll say in Q4, so it needs to be muscle memory, not something you glance at on a call.

Upload your Loom video for your manager's sign-off and then move on to the product section.

Section 2 • The Product: How Skio Actually Works

This is your reference, what each feature actually does, how it's set up, and where its limits are. The next section (The Demo) covers how to *show* this; this section is what you reach for when a prospect asks something off-script and you need the real answer.

This section provides an in-depth overview of the different product categories inside the Skio platform. For specific technical questions, try using #ask-echo in Slack and then ask a SE.

The section is organized the way Skio itself is, by **Acquisition** (getting new subscribers) and **Retention** (keeping them). Skio's own dashboard splits into an *Acquire* and a *Retain* menu, so this mirrors what you'll see on screen.

Be honest about limits

This section names what Skio does NOT do (in-cart upsells, widget A/B testing, etc.). Knowing the gaps cold makes you more credible, not less, and stops you from promising something in a demo that the product can't deliver.

ACQUISITION: getting new subscribers

The Subscription Widget (PDP)

This is the subscribe-and-save selector on the product page, where a shopper chooses one-time vs. subscription, frequency, and plan.

- **OOTB or custom.** Skio supports both an out-of-the-box widget and fully custom widgets.
- **Migrating in? The launch team matches your current design.** If a merchant is coming off a competing solution, Skio's launch team rebuilds the existing widget's look, no agency or dev required. This is a strong migration talking point.
- **Want something brand-new/different?** That's on the merchant to design and build, Skio's team matches an existing widget, it doesn't design net-new custom ones for you.
- **Setup works just like Recharge.** You create selling plans, attach them to products, and use Shopify's theme editor + app block configuration to place the widget on the storefront. Reps who know the Recharge flow already know this.

Upsell limits, know these cold

Skio supports checkout upsells via Shopify's checkout extensions.

Skio **does not currently support in-cart upsells or post-purchase upsells** (Recharge does). If a prospect needs cart or post-purchase upsell today, that's a genuine gap; don't imply otherwise in a demo.

✓ CHECK YOURSELF

1. When a merchant launches with Skio, who builds their existing widget design?
2. If a merchant wants a brand-new custom widget design, whose job is that?
3. Which upsell types does Skio support, and which does it NOT support today?

Bundles / Build-a-Bundle

Skio has a **native** build-a-bundle, no third-party app required. Two turnkey types:

- **Static bundles**, fixed-price bundles (a set number of products at one price).
- **Dynamic bundles**, "buy more, save more" volume logic where the price and discount both scale up as products are added, and back down as they're removed.

Both are out-of-the-box. This is a differentiator, dynamic/volume bundling is something competitors have struggled to deliver (Aloha moved to Skio for this specifically)

SEE EXAMPLES: [Aloha](#), [WeHeartNutrition](#)

✓ CHECK YOURSELF

1. What are the two types of native bundles Skio offers, and how does each price?
2. In a dynamic bundle, what happens to the discount when a subscriber removes products?
3. Name a brand that moved to Skio specifically for volume bundling.

Checkout Link Builder

Found under the **Acquire** dropdown in the Skio dashboard. It generates **prefilled, direct-to-checkout links**: you add one or more products, set quantities, and optionally apply a discount code, and Skio produces a single URL that drops the shopper straight into Shopify checkout with the right product and selling plan already attached.

Why it's an acquisition tool:

- **Removes friction**, skips the PDP and cart entirely, so a campaign click goes right to checkout as a subscriber.
- **Built for campaigns**, ideal for ads, promos, PDP buttons, and influencer/affiliate links where you want the fewest possible clicks to a subscription.
- **Discount baked in**, a promo code applied to the link auto-applies at checkout, so the offer and the path are one and the same.

Position it against its retention cousin

Checkout Link Builder = ACQUISITION (get new customers subscribed). Its counterpart, Quick Actions, = RETENTION (authenticated links that let existing subscribers skip, swap, update card, etc.). Same "one link" idea, opposite ends of the lifecycle. We'll cover Quick Actions in the Retention part.

Checkout Link Builder

Build a checkout link for your customers

Checkout Link

https://demo-ski0-store.myshopify.com/cart/clear?return_to=%2Fcart%2Fadd%3Fitems%

 Copy

Copy this URL and give it to your customer to perform the action in just a few clicks.

Discount code (optional)

If you have a discount code, you can add it here. This will be applied to the checkout link.

First product

+ Add product

Product to include in cart



Apple Cinnamon Overnight Oats
4 Pack

[Edit product](#)

Quantity

1

Selling Plan

One time purchase

Docs: [Ski0. Checkout Link Builder](#)

✓ CHECK YOURSELF

1. Where does the Checkout Link Builder live in the dashboard, and what does the link do when a shopper clicks it?
2. Why is it an acquisition tool rather than a retention tool?
3. What's its retention counterpart, and what's the difference between the two?

RETENTION: keeping subscribers

Customer Portal (CPv3)

The customer portal is where subscribers manage their accounts. Just as Recharge has Affinity v1 and v2, Ski0 has evolved through CPv1, CPv2, and CPv3. **We focus on CPv3**, the current portal. It's a real-time drag-and-drop builder: you control the branding, which actions customers can take, and how everything is laid out.

What's new in v3

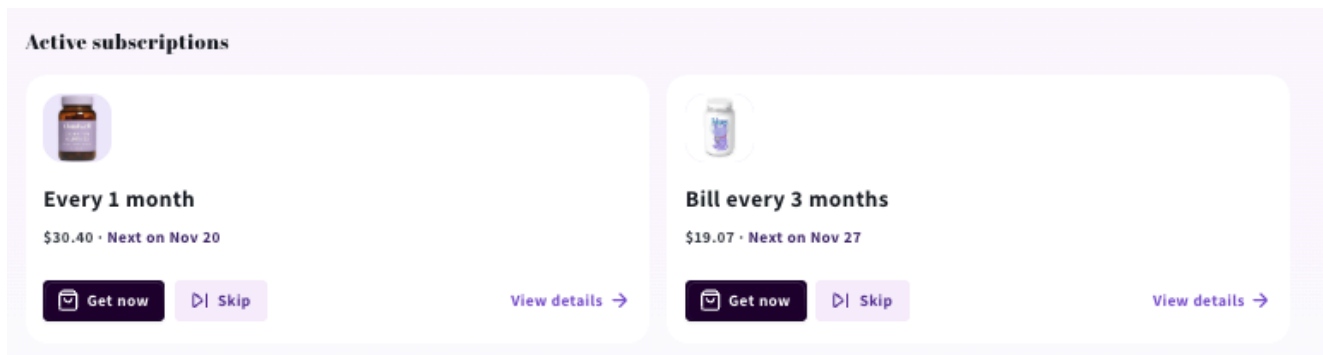
- **Card-based subscription view.** Customers with more than one subscription see them all in a scannable 2×2 card grid instead of a long vertical list. Customers with a single subscription are taken straight to that subscription when they open the portal.
- **Simplified action buttons.** Key actions appear as prominent buttons at the top of each subscription (Get now, Skip, and a "More" menu for additional actions) instead of hunting through the interface.
- **Full merchant customization.** You control colors and branding, which actions customers can take, and how the buttons are organized, so the portal matches your brand and supports your retention strategy.

Subscription overview cards

Each card shows the essentials at a glance:

- Product image
- Subscription frequency
- Next order date
- Order total
- Get Now
- Skip
- **View Details** → more actions available here

You set the order of these cards in the **Layout** section of your branding settings ([help doc](#)).

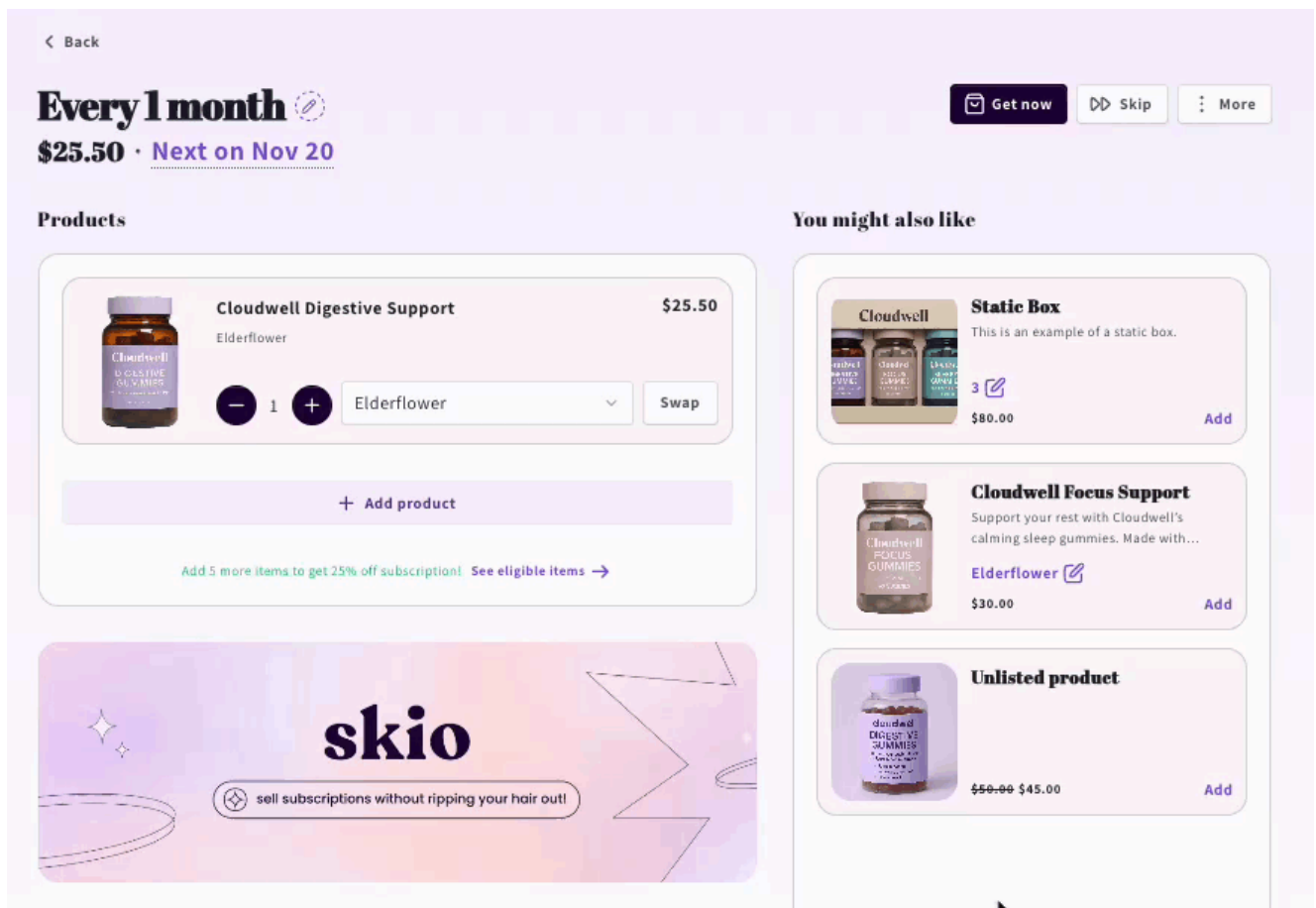


Inside a subscription (View details)

Clicking a card opens the full management view, organized into clear sections:

- **Action buttons** (top right): default to Get now, Skip, and a More menu; you control which appear and in what order.
- **Line items:** all products in the subscription; adjust quantities with +/−, swap for alternatives, or add new products. Upsell recommendations may appear here based on your settings.
- **Shipping address:** the delivery address; Edit to update.

- **Payment method:** the card on file; customers can update billing as needed.
- **Order summary:** subtotal, discounts, shipping, and taxes.
- **Order history:** a separate tab beside Account showing previous orders and their details.
- **Account:** next to Logout; customers update email, phone number, and birth date.



Available actions (you choose which are on)

CPv3 supports the standard actions subscribers expect: Get now, Skip, Pause, Edit frequency, Next order date, Apply discount, Cancel, Merge, Split, Product skip, Gift on skip, and Quantity editing. You decide which are available and how they're organized in the [experience settings](#).

Interval Matching & Auto-Split

What are interval matching and auto-split? By default, the Customer Portal doesn't check billing intervals when a customer browses products to add or swap. A customer on a monthly subscription can see and add a product that's only sold on a quarterly selling plan — a configuration that determines how a product is sold on a subscription, including its price and billing frequency. When that happens, the product bills at the monthly frequency instead of the quarterly cadence it was set up for, which can lead to incorrect billing, product misuse, and support tickets.

Interval matching and auto-split are two different ways to solve this:

Restrict products by subscription interval: Only shows customers products that have a selling plan matching their current subscription's billing interval. Mismatched products are hidden from the add/swap flow entirely.

Enable auto-split on interval mismatch: Shows customers all eligible products, regardless of interval. If a customer adds or swaps in a product with a different interval, Skio automatically creates a separate subscription for it at the correct cadence, instead of adding it to the existing subscription.

"Split" limitation, know this

The Split action **does not appear** for subscriptions that are prepaid, contain a one-time upsell, contain surprise & delight products, or have discounts applied.

Login & Accounts

- **Passwordless login.** A subscriber enters their email and gets a 4-digit 2FA code by email, and by text to the phone on file if there is one.
- **Stays logged in.** After a subscriber logs in once, Skio keeps them logged in on that device, making future management easier.
- **Auto-created accounts.** Skio automatically creates and activates a Skio account at checkout, so no more activation complaints from frustrated subscribers.

Note: this doesn't replace or create the Shopify customer account. It only works if Skio login is active and the customer uses the same email for their subscription and their Shopify account.

Order history

◆ KEY DIFFERENCE vs. RECHARGE

The Order History tab shows ALL customer orders, including non-subscription orders. Recharge did not support this.

✓ CHECK YOURSELF

1. A customer has three active subscriptions, what do they see when they open CPv3, and what changes if they only have one?
2. Name three actions a customer can take from inside a subscription in the portal.
3. Which four situations make the Split action unavailable?
4. Does Skio's auto-created account replace the Shopify customer account, and what has to be true for passwordless login to work?

The Portal Builder

The portal settings page is a real-time, drag-and-drop builder. As you change colors, splash images, banners, or button text, the preview updates instantly. Toggle the right-hand preview across views (subscription detail, subscription overview, order history, and the login screen with your splash images) and switch between desktop and mobile.

When done, click **Publish** (top right); changes go live immediately, the next time a customer opens the portal. For an unpublished portal you'll see a **Save** button for drafts; once published, changes are committed with Publish instead.

Full settings docs: [Branding](#) · [Experience settings](#) · [Advanced settings](#)

Payment Methods

Customers can edit billing, address, and personal info, and add multiple cards, including a backup payment method.

Backup payment methods reduce involuntary churn: if a subscriber's primary card fails, Skio automatically retries the charge on their backup card. They must be **enabled in your Skio dashboard**. Customers add and manage them in two ways: through the Customer Portal (if enabled in portal settings), or via a Quick Action link.

Sending a backup-payment Quick Action link:

- Skio Dashboard → Grow → Quick Actions.
- Create new action → Modify existing subscription.
- Select the action: Set backup payment method.
- Choose link type: Universal, Klaviyo, Sendlane, or Skio.
- (Optional) Attach a discount code as an incentive, set to "once per customer" to prevent reuse.

Backup payment: best practices

Regularly remind customers to add/update a backup card via email (in Klaviyo you can filter out those who already have one).

Offer a small discount to incentivize setup.

Monitor and adjust the messaging based on usage.

Use both the portal callout and Quick Actions so customers have the easiest path to add and manage backup cards.

✓ CHECK YOURSELF

1. What happens when a subscriber's primary card fails and they have a backup card on file?
2. Where must backup payment methods be turned on, and what are the two ways a customer can add one?
3. Why should a discount code attached to a backup-payment link be set to "once per customer"?

Payment Recovery (Dunning)

Payment Recovery manages failed subscription renewals during the **dunning window**, the period that opens when a payment fails and closes when the subscription either renews successfully or cancels. It's a critical moment to prevent churn and recover recurring revenue. Access it at **Retain** → **Payment Recovery** in the dashboard.

It expands on traditional dunning with flexible, multi-phase retry logic built on Skio's newest data model: instead of a single retry limit, you build adaptive recovery campaigns with multiple retry phases, each with its own number of billing attempts and intervals.

Understanding retries

- **Retry the card first.** Attempt multiple retries on the card on file before emailing the subscriber. About 15% of failed payments recover automatically with no customer action, which means fewer emails, lower cancellation risk, fewer support tickets, and a smoother experience.
- **Sensible default.** If you're just starting, set the first retry phase to a 3-day interval with 7 total attempts.

Smart Retries

Smart Retries automatically optimize *when* retries fire (best time of day, day of week, and day of month) using Skio's data model. Your configured total number of retries is always respected, but Skio may adjust the interval for a more effective schedule (e.g., a "every 1 day × 3" phase might become 2 days, then 3, then 4).

- **Enable it** on the Payment Recovery page via the Enable Smart Retries toggle.
- **Reporting.** Subscriptions recovered via Smart Retries are labeled in the Smart Adj. column of the user table.

Best practices

- **Enable Smart Retries.** The single highest-leverage setting; it uses subscriber behavior patterns to pick the most effective retry times.
- **Multiple retry phases.** Configure the first two phases with back-to-back retries on the card, then offer a discount in a third phase.
- **Discount codes in later phases.** Auto-apply a discount during specific phases to lift billing success and nudge a card update. Use a discount code (not an automatic discount), limited to one per customer to prevent misuse.
- **Notify via Klaviyo, but not too early.** Only email the customer after multiple on-file retries in phases 1–2. Skio sends a "Billing attempt failed" metric to Klaviyo per failed charge, including the error code and message, so you can build conditional splits (e.g., for insufficient funds, tell them it'll retry rather than asking them to update their card).

Analytics

The Results tab shows three metrics per phase: **subscriptions currently in phase, recovered in phase** (renewed without progressing), and **progressed to next phase** (failed all attempts and moved on). For deeper insight, use the [Dunning Dashboard](#) in the Analytics section.

Related: backup payment methods (in the Customer Portal section) auto-retry a second card on failure. Pair them with Payment Recovery for the best recovery rate.

✓ CHECK YOURSELF

1. Roughly what share of failed payments recover automatically from card retries alone, before you ever email the customer?
2. What does enabling Smart Retries change, and what does it always respect?
3. In a good multi-phase setup, at what point should you introduce a discount, and at what point should you first notify the customer via Klaviyo?

Splash Screens

A splash screen is a temporary modal that appears *before* the cancel flow officially begins, a "Before you go" moment. It usually holds a video (a founder message or a light/funny clip) that nudges the subscriber toward an alternate action instead of canceling. It's the first line of defense before any survey or treatment step.

- **Any action can be attached.** Skip, swap, choose a specific next order date, order now, pause, or send them to an external link.
- **Segmented.** Run multiple splash screens based on conditions and customer segments, so a different message and offer reach different customers.

Impact worth quoting: adding a splash screen alone has reduced cancellations by ~18% for some merchants.

How to add one: click the + below the Start node (or drag the Splash Screen node from the bottom menu), then click the node to configure it and upload a video or add text/imagery to display before customers enter the main flow.

Cancellation Flows

The cancel flow is the sequence a subscriber hits when they click "cancel," one of Skio's strongest retention surfaces. The Demo section covers how to *show* it; here's what it actually does and how it's built.

Multiple cancel flows

You're no longer limited to one flow. You can run different flows for different segments (e.g., new vs. long-term subscribers):

- **Multiple flows.** Create more than one cancel flow instead of a single one-size-fits-all path.
- **Targeted entry conditions.** Show entirely different flows to different users (e.g., a 1st-order subscriber vs. a 4th-order subscriber) and condition on product subscribed, LTV, tags, and more.
- **Priority ranking.** Built-in conflict resolution so when a customer qualifies for more than one flow, the right flow always wins.
- **Path analytics.** See the exact steps an individual customer took through the flow: where they dropped and which treatment they accepted.
- **Better management.** Built-in translations for new locales, plus automatic version history.

Building a flow: the node types

The cancel flow is a node-based builder: add nodes below the Start node (click + or drag from the bottom menu) and configure each one. The core nodes:

- **Splash Screen:** the "Before you go" modal covered above; sits ahead of the main flow.
- **Cancellation Reason:** the selectable reasons a customer can pick for canceling. Reasons are randomized when the customer enters the flow.
- **Sub Reason:** a follow-up sub-selection that appears after an initial reason is chosen.
- **Other Reason:** a catch-all reason node for anything not covered.
- **Treatment:** the retention offer shown based on the selected reason (discount, pause, skip next order, etc.). Add treatment nodes after each reason.
- **Split Treatments:** randomly split customers between different treatment paths to test strategies; compare with inline analytics later to see which path saves more subscribers.

Testing: Split Treatments vs. A/B testing

- **Split Treatments** split customers across treatment paths within a single flow.
- **A/B testing** operates at the flow level: direct a set % of customers to flow A vs. flow B for measured results.

Branding & preview

- **Customize Flow HTML Section** (Settings, top-right of the builder): style the top of the flow to match branding. Insert `{{ savedBySubscribing }}` to show the customer's total subscription savings, and add custom CSS in a `<style></style>` block. Note: enabling custom HTML disables the custom image/video option for the reason-selection step.
- **Customize Flow Images/Videos:** set a URL for imagery/video at each stage (cancellation reason selection, discount offer, subscription cancelled, changes saved). 16:9 is recommended.
- **Preview panel** (bottom-right): an interactive preview of exactly what customers see, so you can check messaging, reasons, and treatments before saving or activating.

✓ CHECK YOURSELF

1. What is a splash screen, when does it fire relative to the cancel flow, and name three actions you can attach to it.
2. A subscriber qualifies for two different cancel flows. What decides which one they see?
3. What's the difference between Split Treatments and flow-level A/B testing?
4. What does the `{{ savedBySubscribing }}` variable do, and what does enabling custom Flow HTML disable?

Journeys

Journeys is Skio's visual workflow builder, a drag-and-drop way to automate subscription changes across the customer lifecycle. You build "if this, then that" logic that responds to real-time events (an order placed, a product added, a billing date changed), with no code and deep integrations like Klaviyo. [Setup guide](#).

How it works, three node types

- **Trigger node**, when the Journey begins (e.g., after an order, after a product change).
- **Condition node**, the rules that decide which customers follow which path.
- **Action node**, what happens (swap product, apply discount, send notification, etc.).

Combine multiple nodes into a single Journey for full control over how the subscription evolves.

Prebuilt templates

Three come ready to use: Product swap, Upgrade suggestion, and Change discount over time.

Common use cases

- **Trial-to-full-size conversions**, automatically swap a trial SKU for the full-size product after a set cycle, adjusting the price.
- **Bundle expansion / kit splitting**, break a bundled SKU (sold as one Shopify line item) into individual products at a chosen point, so subscribers can swap or remove items.
- **Lifecycle upsell & cross-sell**, add one-time or recurring products after key actions or thresholds; repeatable across the subscriber's lifecycle.
- **In-portal engagement**, interactive portal banners that nudge subscribers (upsell, a last-minute pre-renewal discount, "upsizing" flows).

Triggers (when a Journey starts)

- **After order**, fires after an order completes, both checkout and recurring. Use the Order number filter to tell the two apart.
- **After a product is added**, fires when a product is added or removed from a subscription. Toggle each source on/off: recurring products (subscription lines outside build-a-box), one-time upsells, quantity changes (increases, decreases, removals), and box updates (build-a-box only).
 - **Key callout: it also triggers on product removal**, despite the name, flip the Quantity changes toggle to fire on removals too.
- **After next manual billing date change**, fires after a manual change to the next billing date via Quick Actions or the Customer Portal (Skip, Set Order Date, Temporary Pause, Reactivate).
- **Receive SMS keyword**, fires when a customer texts a keyword you define (e.g., SKIP, SWAP, UPGRADE) to your SMS number. Keywords, follow-ups, and confirmations are configured in Postscript; multiple keywords can map to different Journeys.
 - *Only appears if Postscript is enabled and integrated with Skio ([docs](#)).*

Trigger filters vs. conditions

Trigger filters control which ORDERS trigger the flow. Conditions determine which CUSTOMERS go down each path after it's triggered.

Conditions (which customers follow which path)

Customer-based:

- **Customer tag**, has / does not have a specified tag.
- **Credit balance**, available store or subscription credit.
- **In tier**, currently in specific loyalty tiers.
- **Distance to tier**, how close to the next tier (by order count, LTV, or product count) and current tier.
- **Tier at risk**, tier is at risk of being lost to expiry rules.

Subscription-based:

- **Order number, total quantity, total value**, current order #, product count, or dollar value of the subscription.
- **Creation date, day of week, next billing date, shipping interval**, timing filters.
- **Discount code, subscription note, subscription ID**, match on discount, internal note text, or specific IDs.
- **Is prepaid renewing, migrated from another platform, subscription country, subscription status**, renewing vs. ending prepaid, migrated subs, shipping country (is / is not), and status (active, cancelled, failed, under review, paused).

Product-based:

- **Contains / excludes products**, subscriptions that include (or don't include) a specific product.
- **Contains / does not contain dynamic or static boxes**, filter by build-a-box type.

Other:

- **Audit log**, specific audit-log actions.
- **Cancel Flow**, whether a given rebuttal was shown and the sub was saved or not.
- **Quick Action**, a Quick Action link was actioned, or viewed but not actioned.
- **Surprise & Delight**, customer was or wasn't qualified for a gift.

Actions (what happens)

Swap product · Add discount · Add product · Change delivery price · Change interval · Trigger banner (customized portal banner) · Update product price · Adjust next billing date · Notification (email, SMS, or integration event) · Bundle expansion (replace one product with several) · Delay (by hours or days) · Remove products · Remove discounts · Pause subscription · Swap static boxes · Swap dynamic boxes · Remove box · Award credits · Sunset prepaid (convert a prepaid subscription to recurring).

✓ CHECK YOURSELF

1. What are the three node types in a Journey, and what does each one do?
2. What's the difference between a trigger filter and a condition?
3. The trigger is called "After a product is added." How do you make it fire when a product is removed instead?
4. Name one Journey action that changes pricing and one that changes the schedule.

Segments

A Segment is a filtered view of your subscriptions that meet conditions you define. Use them to compare performance between subscriber groups, export targeted lists for campaigns, and focus analytics on a subset (plan type, churn risk, renewal timing, and more). Segments are the thread that connects the rest of the platform, the same logic layer powers journeys, cancel flows, and reporting.

Static vs. Dynamic

- **Static**, a one-time snapshot of subscribers who met the conditions at creation. Best for point-in-time analysis like cohort comparisons or historical behavior.
- **Dynamic**, auto-updates every night, adding and removing subscriptions as they meet (or stop meeting) the criteria. Best for ongoing monitoring and real-time campaign targeting. (Nightly, not live, use the Refresh icon for an immediate update.)

Creating a Segment

Go to **Tools** → **Segments** → **Create a segment**, then:

- **Name it** with a clear convention (e.g., "High-Value Monthly Subscribers" or "Churn Risk - 90 Days").
- **Choose the type**, Static or Dynamic.
- **Select subscription type**, regular recurring or prepaid (one type per Segment).
- **Set conditions**, click AND condition to stack filters; each one narrows the group further. These are the same conditions used in Journeys (the same four categories: customer-, subscription-, product-based, and other).
- **Preview & create**, Skio shows how many subscriptions will match; confirm the count, then Create segment.

Managing Segments

At **Tools** → **Segments** → **View segments**, the list shows each Segment's name, type (Static/Dynamic), current subscription count, and created date. Per Segment you can:

- **Export**, download the subscription data for external tools or campaigns.
- **View conditions**, see the filter logic.
- **View in analytics**, apply the Segment as a filter in the Segments dashboard to isolate revenue, churn rate, and LTV for that group.
- **Refresh**, pull the latest matches for a Dynamic Segment on demand.

- **Delete**, remove a Segment you no longer need.

Segments can't be edited

There's no edit after creation. To change the filters, delete the Segment and create a new one.

✓ CHECK YOURSELF

1. What's the difference between a Static and a Dynamic segment, and how often does a Dynamic one refresh?
2. Can you edit a segment after creating it? If not, how do you change its filters?
3. Name two things you can do with a segment once it's built.

Loyalty

Skio Loyalty boosts lifetime value and reduces churn by rewarding shoppers for purchases and brand engagement. Unlike bolt-on loyalty apps, it's built to integrate with subscriptions, a **subscription-first** program that works for both one-time purchases and subscribers. Mix and match the pieces: run a full program or start with one. It breaks into three parts, **Tiers & Rewards, Credits, and Referrals**. [Getting started](#).

1. Tiers & Rewards

Gamified tiers that reward customers for staying active and spending more. Why it works: drives repeat purchases and LTV (higher tiers unlock better perks), improves retention (tier expiration and requalification windows keep people engaged), builds emotional loyalty (recognition + exclusive perks), and gives you a segmentation handle on your highest-value customers. [Setup](#).

Example: a supplements brand starts everyone in **Core** (100 pts per \$1). At \$200 spent in a 6-month window they hit **Elevate** (1.5× points, early access to drops); at \$500 they reach **Peak** (2× points, quarterly gift boxes, +10% off all subscription orders), reinforcing healthy habits and nudging subscription upgrades.

2. Credits

Reward customers with redeemable store credit for purchases and brand interactions. Why it works: credits pull customers back to redeem (order frequency ↑), lift AOV (they add to cart to maximize credit), **preserve margin and brand pricing** (use credits instead of blanket discounts), reward non-purchase actions (reviews, referrals, signups), and support win-back with expiring/bonus credits for at-risk customers. [Setup](#).

Example: earn \$1 credit per \$20 spent, auto-applied at checkout, plus bonus credits on a birthday, for a product review, or a newsletter signup, turning loyalty into tangible savings and more brand touchpoints.

3. Referrals

Turn your best customers into a growth channel with rewards for both the referrer and the new customer. Why it works: low-cost acquisition, higher trust and conversion (personal recommendation), referred customers spend more and stay longer, and you can track and reward top advocates. [Setup](#).

Example: each customer gets a unique link, the friend gets \$10 off their first order, the referrer earns \$10 in store credit, promoted in email and on account pages to make sharing easy.

Where customers see it, the two Rewards pages

Enabling any Loyalty feature automatically creates a Rewards page inside the customer portal, no extra storefront setup. It's personalized per customer and adapts to show only the features you've enabled. In CPv3, customers reach it from the cashback banner on the subscription overview, the banner arrow in the detail view, or "View more rewards" when redeeming credits.

- **Customer Portal Rewards page**, inside the portal, visible only to logged-in customers, auto-created and personalized. Here they view rewards, redeem credits, generate discount codes, grab their referral link, and see rewards history.
- **Rewards landing page**, a public storefront page (a custom Shopify page) that promotes the program to anyone, including prospects. Not personalized; it explains how the program works and what customers can earn. [Setup](#).

The Loyalty Widget (PDP)

The Loyalty Widget is a Shopify theme block that shows shoppers how much credit they'll earn on a purchase, right on the product page. It renders dynamically and updates automatically whenever your reward settings change, you only maintain the reward config in one place.

On page load it calculates the credit a customer will earn from your reward configuration: **logged-in customers see their tier-adjusted reward**; anonymous visitors see the base rate with a prompt to sign in. Adding it works exactly like the subscription widget, through Shopify's theme editor with app blocks.

Display settings (click the Skio Loyalty Widget block in the theme editor's left panel):

- **Mode**, show rewards as \$ (cash), Credits, or Both. Defaults to cash.
- **Show Balance**, toggle on to display a logged-in customer's current credit balance.
- **Logged-in message**, default You'll earn {amount} back in {creditName}.
- **Anonymous message**, default Sign in to earn {amount} back in {creditName}.
- **Balance message**, shown when Show Balance is on; default You have {balance}.
- **Login URL**, where the sign-in prompt sends customers; defaults to /a/account/login.
- **Styling**, text color, background, border color, radius, width, and icon.

✓ CHECK YOURSELF

1. What are the three parts of Skio Loyalty?
2. What's the difference between the Customer Portal Rewards page and the Rewards landing page?
3. What does the Loyalty Widget show on a PDP, and how does a logged-in shopper's view differ from an anonymous one?
4. Name one advantage of rewarding with credits instead of blanket discounts.

Winbacks

Winbacks mirror Recharge's winback capability. The **cancellation is the trigger**, once a subscriber cancels, they're routed down different paths built from landing pages and emails designed to bring them back. It can also be integrated with Klaviyo, so the win-back messaging runs alongside your existing lifecycle flows.

SkioSMS

SkioSMS is Skio's built-in transactional SMS and subscription-management tool. It does two jobs:

- **One-way notifications**, automated messages for events like billing reminders, successful orders, failed payments, skips, and cancellations.
- **Two-way subscription management**, customers text back (e.g., MENU or MODIFY) to skip, pause, change an order date, swap products, add items, and more. Cancellation routes them through the Customer Portal, so your Cancel Flow and churn reporting still apply.

You can customize message copy, use customer/subscription variables, set quiet hours, test in a simulator, and review message history and engagement analytics. Customers opt out with STOP/CANCEL and resubscribe with START, UNSTOP, or YES.

Number setup, Skio provisions it

You don't need to bring your own SMS provider or phone number.

- **Skio assigns your store a dedicated Twilio-powered number** for transactional subscription messages.
- **On first enable** (Retain → SkioSMS), Skio walks you through the required toll-free verification (for non-UK merchants).
- **The number can't send until Twilio completes verification**, status is visible in SkioSMS Settings.
- **Included at no additional cost** with your Skio account.

Regional note

For UK merchants, and generally Canada, Australia, or other non-US countries, number provisioning may require manual/regional setup. Contact Skio Support to provision a local number; availability depends on country-specific carrier and regulatory requirements.

How it fits with Postscript / Attentive / Klaviyo SMS

Those tools are still used for marketing SMS or Skio event-triggered campaigns, but they're separate from SkioSMS. The common setup:

- **SkioSMS number**, transactional subscription notices + two-way subscription management.
- **Marketing provider's number**, promotional campaigns and marketing automations.

Keeping them separate ensures a customer who opts out of marketing texts doesn't also miss important billing or subscription-management messages.

✓ CHECK YOURSELF

1. What are the two jobs SkioSMS does?
2. Do you need to bring your own phone number or SMS provider? How does the number get set up?
3. How does SkioSMS relate to a marketing SMS tool like Postscript or Attentive, and why keep them on separate numbers?

Analytics & Reporting

Skio's dashboards span subscriptions, retention, cancellations, dunning, cohorts/LTV, and loyalty. Rather than memorize them, spend time clicking through every dashboard in your own demo store, get familiar with where each metric lives so you can navigate them confidently and answer a prospect's "can you show me churn by cohort?" live, without hunting.

Email Notifications

Skio includes built-in, one-way email notifications for key subscription events (order confirmation / portal reminder, billing reminder, billing-attempt failure, skip, cancel, order-date change, surprise & delight, prepaid gift, and more) at no extra cost. Each is customizable, subject, content, sender, timing, dynamic + Quick Action variables, or can be routed through Klaviyo instead. They live at **Retain** → **Email Notifications**.

Review on your own

This one's for self-study, skim the notification list and defaults so you can speak to the full lifecycle of messages a subscriber receives.

Reference: [Skio, Email Notifications](#)

That's the Product reference

You now have the full feature reference for how Skio works. The next section, The Demo, shows how to put it in front of a merchant.

Section 3 • The Demo: How to Run a Great Skio Demo

You each have your own demo store, this section is your run of show for it. We're not covering every feature; we're covering the *most important* ones in the order you'll demo them. The whole flow below is a live demo against your own store, using the merchant's products and branding wherever possible.

Where to spend your time

Go deep on: Customer Portal, Journeys, Cancel Flow, and Volume Discounts. These are the moments that win deals.

Keep it light on: PDP widget, Analytics, unless a technical/data buyer is on the call, in which case Analytics is where you win them (see step 9).

Golden rule: say it, own it, move on. A tight flow beats a feature tour every time.

◆ KEY DIFFERENCE vs. RECHARGE

Keep this soundbite ready, "What's the difference between Skio and Recharge?" comes up unprompted.

Nick's clean answer: "Recharge was built 12 years ago, before Shopify's Subscriptions API, so a lot of custom logic is baked in, it's more for complex-API customers. Skio was built after 2020 as a wrapper around the Subscriptions API: faster shipping, faster portal, GraphQL instead of REST. It's just a faster tool, and it's where our R&D is going for brands like yours. A lot of merchants are upgrading to the Skio tech."

Note the framing: "upgrading," not "switching."

1. Set the Stage

Pull up a live customer website and lead with it immediately, don't wait for them to notice the Skio branding. Open with the approved talk track (same one from Section 1):

"Before we jump in, quick bit of context. You're going to see Skio when we pull up the platform today. Skio is now a Recharge brand; we acquired them earlier this year, and the Skio tech is where we're investing our R&D going forward for brands just like you. Skio's built natively on Shopify's Subscriptions API, which means we ship faster than anyone in the space, stay closest to Shopify's roadmap, and everything works out of the box without custom workarounds.

The brands you probably know in this space, Grüns, IM8, Dose Daily, Neuro Gum, Instant Hydration, they're all running on the Skio tech. These are the fastest-growing subscription brands, and what you're about to see is exactly what they're running on."

Then move straight into the demo. Say it, own it, move on. A natural way top reps set it up: "You'll probably see Skio everywhere today, that's on purpose."

Set the deliverable early: "We also build a custom demo environment for every brand we work with. I'll walk you through it today and send it over as a resource for you and your team to review, the goal is to see what this looks like with your products, your branding, and your store."

2. PDP, Subscription Widget + Conversion Tools

Don't over-index here, this is **not** a key differentiator in the space. The same talk tracks you used at Recharge apply. Hit it and keep moving:

"The front end starts exactly like any Shopify store, someone finds a product, adds to cart, checks out. But here's where it gets interesting: most brands are stitching together three or four different apps to influence that journey, one for cart upsells, another for checkout cross-sells, another for subscription conversion. Recharge consolidates all of that into one platform.

Right in the cart, we can prompt a one-time buyer to switch to a subscription and save, and surface a complementary product at the same time. On Shopify Plus, we extend that into checkout itself: subscription upgrade, cross-sell, even a frequency swap.

This is the new kingpin strategy for our fastest-scaling merchants, it lets you collect 3–4 months of cash upfront. Once you have that advance on cashflow, you can scale fast and accelerate growth. They're not waiting until post-purchase to optimize, they're shaping subscriber behavior at the exact moment someone commits. Grüns does this very well in their portal too."

Second-bite play (top reps use this): if the buyer doesn't take the bigger commitment on the PDP, catch them in the portal after order 1 with an "upgrade to quarterly" banner. "Grüns promotes upgrade-to-quarterly right in the portal once the customer's acquired, so you optimize cash flow on both ends: acquisition and post-order-one."

Further reading: [X post on the upfront-cash / cart-conversion strategy](#)

Front-end stores to demo:

- [Dose Daily](#), Subscribe & save
- [Transparent Labs](#), Subscribe & save
- [Grüns](#), Custom widget
- [IM8](#), Quantity upsell
- [Neuro Gum](#), Subscribe & save
- [Instant Hydration](#), Subscribe & save

Clarify with the merchant

New subscription programs: our implementations engineer sets them up with the out-of-the-box widget and/or Bundles. Showcase OOTB at [demo-skio-store.myshopify.com](#) (password: skio).

Migrations: implementation engineers match parity with what the merchant has today, for both the widget and bundles.

A/B testing the widget: Skio does not have this

If the merchant asks, use this reframe:

"We looked into A/B testing the widget pretty deeply as we enhanced our tech. The problem with testing price on the widget is you'd have two customers on the same site, one sees \$39, one sees \$34, and neither converts because they don't trust the price. What we do instead is segmentation: take

that same test, apply it to a defined cohort, let it run, and measure against your baseline. You get the data without undermining your brand."

If they have no subscription program, show the standard OOTB widget from the Skio Demo Store. Flag that customization exists via agencies/partners but isn't your team's scope. Show the range, basic to advanced, and keep it brief.

HOMEWORK

Build it or find it: set up a subscription widget on a PDP in your demo store, or find a live merchant with a great subscribe-and-save + cart/checkout upsell moment.

Paste a link (your demo store or a merchant's store) with a 1-2 sentence note on why you chose it and how it shows off the PDP conversion moment.

Goal: collect several real examples per feature so you always have one ready to pull up on a call.

3. Volume Discounts, Build-a-Box & Bundles

Lead with this for any consumable / CPG catalog, it's a **top-tier differentiator**. Skio is the only platform in the space that has made **volume discounts** work: buy-more-save-more logic where the discount scales up as a subscriber adds products and scales back down if they remove them.

"We're the only company in the space that's brought volume discounts to life. As a subscriber adds more products, the discount grows, and if they downgrade their stack, it scales back with them. It's the natural way to grow AOV: people don't buy everything at once, but on order 3 or 4 you dynamically nudge them to add more and save more."

Proof to name-drop: **Aloha** came to Skio for this after 3 different agencies and 3 different builds elsewhere couldn't pull it off; **Mozy** moved for the same reason. Ultra runs it live with the discount auto-applied in the portal.

Build-a-Box / bundles are great for brands with 2-3 SKUs that want to raise AOV:

- [Just Ingredients](#), Build a Bundle
- [Bulletproof Coffee](#), Build a Bundle

Bundles are native and turnkey too, **static** (fixed-price) and **dynamic** (buy-more-save-more), no third-party app required. (See the Product section for the full detail.)

HOMEWORK

Build it or find it: build a dynamic (buy-more-save-more) bundle in your demo store, or find a merchant running volume discounts or a build-a-box well.

Paste a link with a 1-2 sentence note on why you chose it and how it highlights volume/bundle logic.

Goal: collect several real examples so you always have one ready to pull up.

4. Customer Portal

This is where you spend real time. Walk through, live:

- Editing frequency
- Pushing the next order date
- Swapping products
- Adding a one-time item

"The goal is to give customers four different ways to take the same action. The number one reason someone calls your support team is because they can't figure out how to skip or delay an order. We make that impossible to miss."

Also show these, differentiators reps consistently win with:

- **Passwordless login / magic link.** Skio auto-creates an account on the first order; customers get a 4-digit code + magic link, no password resets. "Login is your most important touchpoint when someone comes back to manage a subscription, so we strip out all the friction."
- **Smart upsell carousel.** Recommends products based on what they're already subscribed to, and won't show them what they already have. Handled very differently from Recharge/Stay. Medterra grew AOV \$6 within 2-3 weeks of turning it on.
- **Backup payment method.** Customers store a backup card that auto-retries on failure, a direct answer to involuntary/dunning churn.
- **"Get it now."** Place the next order immediately, one of the only platforms that offers it.
- **Skip at the individual-product level,** skip one item in a multi-product subscription without skipping or churning the whole order.

Then flip to the backend and show the **modular portal builder**, drag and drop, no code, built like Shopify's own theme editor (~5x faster to edit than anyone else). Custom blocks let you inject things like a "days healing your gut" counter without breaking out of the portal.

Customer portals to show (Aidan's accounts, magic links):

- [Graymatter Labs](#)
- [IM8](#)
- [Grüns](#)

These are live accounts, look, don't touch

Show the functionality only. Do NOT change or swap anything. Do NOT cancel.

If they raise failed payments / Shop Pay pain (they will)

Dunning is a real Skio strength and it comes up on almost every call. Talk track: "We were the first team to build dunning natively into a subscription platform, no ARPU or Churn Buster bolt-ons. Our smart retries time each attempt around payday and the customer's time zone, and card recovery is

one tap from an email. Fewer failed charges, higher recovery, and healthier standing with your processor."

HOMEWORK

Build it or find it: reskin a portal in the builder to a mock brand, or find a live merchant portal that nails the subscriber experience.

Paste a link (your demo store or a merchant's magic-link/portal) with a note on why you chose it and how it highlights the portal.

Goal: collect several real examples so you always have one ready to pull up.

5. Journeys

A money moment, **build one live on the call**. The key is to uncover what part of their current subscription program a Journey can simplify. If they're net new, advise on best practices for their vertical and merchandising model.

Common patterns:

- Welcome kit → refill (great for supplements)
- High-discount order 1 → change discount on order 2
- Increasing discounts over time

"Let's say you sell a trial kit and you want to automatically swap someone to a full size after their first order. Watch how long this takes."

Build it in real time, condition, action, notification, then land the punch:

"That took two minutes. Imagine everything else you can do with this."

HOMEWORK

Build it or find it: build a Journey (e.g., a trial→full-size swap) in under 2 minutes, or find a merchant using journeys cleverly.

Paste a link or a screenshot/Loom with a note on why you chose it and how it highlights journeys.

Goal: collect several real examples so you always have one ready to pull up.

6. Surprise & Delight + Streaks

For supplement brands, connect this directly to product consumption cycles. Build one on the call and show how easy it is.

"If someone takes your product consistently for 90 days, they're more likely to see results and less likely to churn. Streaks let you reward consecutive billing cycles, don't skip your first three orders, get X."

Push the **behavior-modification** angle, it's newer and it lands: reward the actions you want and gently deter the ones you don't. Examples: multipliers on expiring loyalty credits to drive reactivation, or a skip-deterrent ("skip one more time and you lose free shipping" vs. "don't skip and we'll add \$5 to your next order").

Prep for the ROI skeptic

Sharp merchants push back that automated gifting eats margin (Heart & Soil did, hard). Don't oversell. Reframe: "You don't run it for everyone, you target only the high-risk cohorts and moments, like the order 1→2 and 3→4 drop-offs, so the spend goes where churn actually happens."

HOMEWORK

Build it or find it: build a surprise & delight or streak rule in your demo store, or find a merchant example of gifting/gamified retention.

Paste a link or screenshot with a note on why you chose it and how it highlights surprise & delight or streaks.

Goal: collect several real examples so you always have one ready to pull up.

7. Cancel Flow

One of the strongest closes in the demo. Walk through it as a customer first, click cancel, see the offer. Then flip to the backend:

"Here's the key thing: that offer I just saw isn't what your Day 1 subscriber sees. Because I've been with this brand for 10+ orders and spent X dollars, I'm getting a premium retention offer. You can segment your cancel flow by LTV, order count, whatever condition matters to you."

Walk it as a customer first, and open on the **splash screen**, a founder video, testimonial, or before/after, before any survey. "A splash screen like this alone has cut cancellations by ~18%."

Then show the backend depth: nested reasons → sub-reasons → treatment paths, and completely different flows by segment. "A brand-new customer canceling in the first 3 days sees a totally different flow than someone 10 orders in." Mention holiday-specific flows, and that whole flows can be A/B tested (% split to flow A vs. B).

HOMEWORK

Build it or find it: build a cancel flow with a splash screen and an LTV-segmented offer, or find a merchant cancel flow worth copying (run through one as a customer).

Paste a link or screenshot with a note on why you chose it and how it highlights the cancel flow.

Goal: collect several real examples so you always have one ready to pull up.

8. Segmentation

"Everything I've shown you today is powered by the same logic layer, conditions. You define who sees what, when, and why."

This is where the bulk of customer behavior is tracked. Every customer can be segmented via **static or dynamic** segmentation. Tie it back to the cancel flow, journeys, and widget tests you just showed, it's the thread that connects the whole demo.

HOMEWORK

Build it or find it: build a "churn risk" segment in your demo store and open it in analytics, or find a merchant example of segment-driven personalization.

Paste a link or screenshot with a note on why you chose it and how it highlights segmentation.

Goal: collect several real examples so you always have one ready to pull up.

9. Analytics & Reporting

Surface-level for most buyers, show the dashboard and flag that everything ties to subscriber behavior (LTV, churn reasons, cohort data). **But read the room:** if there's a data or engineering buyer on the call, this is where you win them, so go deep.

If a technical buyer is on the call

Don't skim, this is your differentiator. Skio's data story: raw + aggregate data via BigQuery, a GraphQL API (devs love it, we're the only one with it), the state-change table, and two flavors of webhooks. Offer a warehouse / BigQuery share and the exact queries so their team can validate every number themselves.

Aidan's posture works: "Give me the use case you'd build, we may have an out-of-the-box way that saves you from touching the API." Consult first; don't just say yes to every integration ask.

HOMEWORK

Build it or find it: pull up the analytics dashboard that best tells a retention story (LTV, churn reasons, cohorts) and be ready to walk it live, or find a merchant scenario it explains well.

Paste a link or screenshot with a note on which dashboard you'd lead with and why.

Goal: collect several real examples so you always have one ready to pull up.

10. Loyalty

Qualify before you show it:

"Are you looking for order-based milestone rewards, or true point-based loyalty?"

Skio's **core offering** includes:

- Order-based milestones
- Surprise & delight
- Increasing discounts

Skio's **Loyalty solution** (comparable to Yotpo / Rivo / Bubblehouse) includes:

- Points

- Credits
- Tiers
- Referrals

The wedge: it's the first **subscription-first** loyalty program, built in-house (born when Yotpo wound down their program) so rewards live in the same portal as the subscription, not bolted on with discount codes copied between two apps. "Everything works in cohesion, one portal, one report."

Don't push loyalty on a brand with zero subscription revenue

Get them live on core features first. The renewals team will upsell loyalty later.

HOMEWORK

Build it or find it: turn on a Loyalty feature and confirm the Rewards page in your demo store, or find a merchant with a strong loyalty/rewards program.

Paste a link or screenshot with a note on why you chose it and how it highlights loyalty.

Goal: collect several real examples so you always have one ready to pull up.

Proof-point bank (grab the one that fits the vertical)

Concrete brand + outcome lines land harder than a feature list. Keep these handy:

- **Volume discounts:** Aloha moved to Skio after 3 agencies / 3 failed builds elsewhere; Mozy moved for the same reason.
- **Smart upsell carousel:** Medterra grew AOV \$6 within 2–3 weeks of turning it on.
- **Cancel-flow splash screen:** ~18% reduction in cancellations.
- **Migration speed:** 5-day Lolavie migration when they were about to lose their subscribers, but don't lead with migrations. "We don't win on migrations; we win on the product."
- **Marquee brands:** Grüns, IM8 (fastest brand to \$100M), Dose Daily, Everyday Dose, Bulletproof, Gray Matter.

Section 4 • Talk Tracks & Competitive

The acquisition redrew the competitive map. **Skio is off the board** as a competitor, it's what we sell now, and **Recharge is us**, so "why did you change platforms?" is an objection to handle, not a rival to beat. This section holds the approved positioning and FUD for the brands we actually compete with now, plus objection handling.

The competitive set

Four situations, in order of how often you'll hit them: **Loop** (by far the most common), **Stay**, **budget apps** (Appstle, Seal, etc.), and **Ordergroove**. Keep it factual, the closer only works if every claim holds up.

vs. Loop

Loop is the most common competitive situation.

When they're new to subscriptions

- **You get one chance to build it right.** Recharge helps set the foundation for the entire subscriber experience on day one. Loop gets you live cheap, but you'll hit the ceiling faster than you think, migrating subscribers later is painful and risky. Better to start on the same platform you'll still be on at \$100K MRR.
- **The team behind it.** Loop doesn't have a merchant success team that comes from Shopify and Klaviyo or that are subscription experts. You want a true extension of your team to help grow the program, not just a platform to run it on. That's the difference between going live and actually scaling.
- **The data.** Recharge's smart retries, cancel-flow segmentation, and journey logic are powered by data from 20,000+ brands. Loop works off a small fraction of that. For a brand with big goals, the platform that recovers failed payments and reduces early churn faster is worth the extra cost.
- **Feature access.** New features hit Recharge 6–12 months before Loop. You're not just buying what exists today, you're buying where the platform is going.

When they're migrating off Loop

"It's kind of like a MailChimp or OmniSend to Klaviyo relationship. Lower-cost tool, a little less pretty, a little less refined. That works when you're getting a business off the ground. But as you grow, you need something more polished, on the subscription experience, the admin, the analytics, and the strategic support behind it."

Proof points to hit

- **Market signal.** Grüns, IM8, Dose Daily, Carpe, Instant Hydration, the fastest-growing subscription brands chose Recharge. That's not a coincidence.
- **Portal UX.** Loop's portal is functional but basic. Ours is built to match how a valued subscriber should feel, premium, self-serve, modular.

- **Rewards & gifting.** Loop uses static image uploads for rewards, when a product goes out of stock, the image breaks. Ours pulls live product images automatically.
- **Data & team.** Our merchant success team comes from Shopify, Klaviyo, or tenured Recharge, they understand your data because they've lived in this ecosystem. Based in North America, so no time-zone challenges.
- **Smart retries.** 20,000+ brands' worth of data is what tells you the right time to retry a card, when to send a notification, and what sequence drives recovery. Loop works off a fraction of that, and it directly impacts how much of your failed-payment revenue you recover.
- **Data portability.** Before committing to any platform, ask about data portability and migration support if you ever need to leave. Not all platforms make that easy, worth knowing upfront.
- **Investor / exit risk.** If a brand is on a trajectory toward acquisition or fundraising, Loop's ownership structure is a flag sophisticated investors will surface. Worth knowing upfront.

The closer

"I'm not going to throw logos in your face and tell you that's why you should use us. All it means is that we've won the market with the brands that care most about their subscriber experience. The question is whether that matters to you."

Marquee Loop wins (brands we've pulled over): Blueprint by Bryan Johnson, Resilia, LarineCo, Manly, BLYSS.

HOMEWORK

Record a 2-3 minute Loom delivering the Loop talk track in your own words: the new-to-sub angles, the proof points, and the closer.

Paste your Loom link for manager review.

vs. Stay

Recharge has led the subscription space for 10+ years. Stay came up around the same time as Skio, the difference is what each company did with that time.

"Skio built impressive tech and a reputation for scaling some of the fastest-growing CPG brands on Shopify, which is exactly why we acquired them. Stay spent that same window investing heavily in marketing and telling the world how great they were. The result is that we're consistently six to twelve months ahead of where they land on features, we ship and iterate on products before they even get there."

The bigger difference is what you get after you sign. Our merchant success team comes from Shopify, from Klaviyo, from operators who've actually built and scaled subscription programs. They're not learning your business from scratch, they've lived in this ecosystem. That's who's in your corner. Stay is a solid marketing company. We're an engineering company backed by 10 years of subscription data and a team that actually knows how to grow your program."

Traps to watch for

- **They'll lead with price.** Counter with total cost of ownership, add up the tools they don't include natively that you'd have to bolt on elsewhere.
- **They'll claim feature parity.** Ask them to build a journey live on the call. See how long it takes.
- **They'll lean on brand recognition.** Counter with proof, Grüns, IM8, Dose Daily, Carpe chose Recharge. That's not a coincidence.

The boomerang stat

20 brands migrated from Recharge to Stay.ai over the past 24 months, 12 are already back on our platform, with more in the pipeline.

Marquee Stay.ai wins (brands we've pulled over): Dose Daily, Graymatter, Truvani, Moonbrew, Moon Juice, Apothékary.

📎 HOMEWORK

Record a Loom delivering the Stay talk track and the three traps to watch for (price, feature parity, brand recognition), with your counter to each.

Paste your Loom link for manager review.

vs. Budget Apps (Appstle, Seal, etc.)

These come up mostly on price. Handle it directly, before they anchor on the number.

"If price is the number-one concern and the budget just isn't there, I'll be straight with you, I don't recommend us. There are tools that'll get you live for less. What I'd say is that the brands doing real volume on subscriptions almost always hit a ceiling with those platforms, features you can't get, analytics you can't act on, subscriber experiences that feel cheap. When that happens, they come back. I'd rather you make the right call now than migrate twice."

If they're early-stage with no subscription revenue yet, don't push. Get them to a point where the math makes sense, then revisit.

vs. Ordergroove

"Ordergroove is a great company, they do a lot of great work and work with some really big brands. That said, there are a few key differences between how we run our companies."

- **Shopify-native, not SFCC.** Recharge and Skio were both built for Shopify, and it's the only platform we work with. Ordergroove was originally built for Salesforce Commerce Cloud, so their Shopify solutions are often incomplete, or filled in with custom code built for your store.
- **Dev-team lock-in.** Their "edge" is matching the exact functionality you need, which really means their dev team builds one-off features for you. Every change after that requires their dev team: change orders, new fees, slow turnaround.

- **Productized + API.** We productize new feature requests so every merchant gets them turnkey. If the platform can't do 100% of what you need, our robust API covers the gap, but our team stays out of it (your team or an agency handles it), which means faster implementations, better R&D, and less tech debt as you grow. The same reasons you'd choose Shopify over SFCC are why you'd choose Recharge/Skio over Ordergroove.
- **Poor contracts.** Ordergroove relies on 3-year terms to lock you in and then forget about you; a 1-year term often gets forced into a multi-year renewal. We talk to merchants all the time who feel stuck with a vendor that won't respond to them.

HOMEWORK

Record a Loom walking through the four Ordergroove differences (Shopify-native vs. SFCC, dev-team lock-in, productized + API, poor contracts) in your own words.

Paste your Loom link for manager review.

Post-acquisition objections

The acquisition-specific objections you'll hear. Pricing is covered under Budget Apps above; the three below still need approved language, *paste when ready*.

"Why did you change platforms? What happened to Recharge?"

[Paste approved response, lean on the "upgrade, not a switch / where our R&D is going" framing from the Narrative.]

"Are we being forced off Recharge?"

[Paste approved response.]

"How does migration work / how risky is it?"

[Paste approved response, don't lead with migration, but reassure.]

Practice this live

These competitive and objection talk tracks are part of the capstone in Section 5, reps handle at least two live objections to get certified.

Section 5 • Skio Certification

Reading the course isn't the finish line, **building in the product is**. The homework and quizzes are woven through every section: as you read, you film Looms, build features in your own demo store, and check yourself with the quizzes. This page is where it all comes together, a checklist that confirms you did the work, plus a capstone that proves you can sell it.

How certification works

Do the HOMEWORK and CHECK YOURSELF quizzes as you go, section by section, in your own demo store.

Save your proof (Looms, screenshots, demo-store links) as you collect it.

Get your manager to initial each line of the checklist below as you finish it.

Once the checklist is complete, book your capstone. Pass the rubric and you're Skio Certified.

Certification checklist

- ☐ **Narrative:** acquisition-story Loom recorded and approved.
- ☐ **Product / Acquisition:** passed the widget, bundles, and checkout-link quizzes.
- ☐ **Product / Retention:** passed the portal, payment, payment-recovery, cancel-flow, journeys, segments, loyalty, and SMS quizzes.
- ☐ **Demo:** collected and linked at least one real example for each demo step (your demo store or a live merchant), with a note on why.
- ☐ **Competitive:** Looms recorded for Loop, Stay, and Ordergroove.

Capstone: the Certified Demo

Run a full, recorded mock demo against your demo store to a peer or manager, following the Demo run-sheet.

Handle at least two live objections, e.g. "Does it do in-cart upsells?", "What's the difference vs. Recharge?", "How does migration work?"

Score at least 20 / 25 on the rubric below to pass.

Capstone rubric (score each 1 to 5)

- Opened with the talk track and framed Skio as "us," not a separate company.
- Navigated the product live without fumbling.
- Showed the three deep-value moments: Portal, Journeys, Cancel Flow.
- Positioned honestly and owned the limits instead of dodging them.
- Handled objections and reached for the right proof point.

Skio Certified: final sign-off

All checklist items initialed by manager: _____

Capstone rubric score (min 20/25): _____

Rep name: _____ Date: _____

Certified by: _____